

# Psalms 64

## *Hide Me from the Secret Counsel of the Wicked*

Hide me from the secret counsel of the wicked

KJV · Standalone study handout

### 1 • THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Hear my voice, O God, in my prayer: preserve my life from fear of the enemy.
- 2 Hide me from the secret counsel of the wicked; from the insurrection of the workers of iniquity:
- 3 Who whet their tongue like a sword, and bend their bows to shoot their arrows, even bitter words:
- 4 That they may shoot in secret at the perfect: suddenly do they shoot at him, and fear not.
- 5 They encourage themselves in an evil matter: they commune of laying snares privily; they say, Who shall see them?
- 6 They search out iniquities; they accomplish a diligent search: both the inward thought of every one of them, and the heart, is deep.
- 7 But God shall shoot at them with an arrow; suddenly shall they be wounded.
- 8 So they shall make their own tongue to fall upon themselves: all that see them shall flee away.
- 9 And all men shall fear, and shall declare the work of God; for they shall wisely consider of his doing.
- 10 The righteous shall be glad in the LORD, and shall trust in him; and all the upright in heart shall glory.

### 2 • CONTEXT

A prayer of David against conspirators who plot in secret, using sharpened words like arrows and confident that no one sees their schemes. Henry contrasts the hidden plotting of the wicked with the hidden protection David seeks from God—both operate unseen, but only one succeeds. MacArthur-style notes emphasize the sudden reversal at verse 7: what the wicked shoot secretly, God shoots back suddenly and publicly.

### 3 • VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

#### Verse 1-4

"Hear my voice, O God... hide me from the secret counsel of the wicked... Who whet their tongue like a sword, and bend their bows to shoot their arrows, even bitter words." Slander and conspiracy are described as literal weapons aimed "privily at the perfect," ambushing the innocent without warning.

#### Verse 5-6

"They encourage themselves in an evil matter: they commune of laying snares privily; they say, Who shall see them?... they search out iniquity; they accomplish a diligent search." Wickedness here is organized and confident of concealment, presuming no divine witness.

#### Verse 7-10

The reversal: "But God shall shoot at them with an arrow; suddenly shall they be wounded." Their own tongue causes them to fall; all who see will fear and declare God's work; the righteous will be glad in the Lord, trust in Him, and glory.

### 4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

#### Meaning.

Secret conspiracies that presume "Who shall see them?" forget the God who sees in secret and shoots suddenly in reply—hidden wickedness eventually meets hidden justice, turning public fear into public praise.

#### Application for life today.

When you are the target of hidden slander or scheming, ask God specifically to "hide" you rather than trying to expose or out-manuever every plot yourself. Remember that presumed secrecy is always an illusion before God. Let confidence in God's sudden justice free you to be glad and trust rather than obsessively monitoring conspirators.

### 5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no "right length" answers—honesty before God is the aim.

**1.** Have you experienced something like "secret counsel" or hidden opposition against you—how does this psalm shape your response?

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**2.** Where might you be tempted to "search out iniquity" against others in ways this psalm condemns?

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**3.** How does trusting God's sudden reversal (v. 7) change how much energy you spend managing hidden threats?

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Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Group / Church: \_\_\_\_\_

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).